

Harbin Mahjong Rules

Rules Summary

December 29, 2025

Quick reference for table play

How to Win (and Ting)

- ▶ **You must be in Ting** to be eligible to win.
- ▶ **Winning pattern:** Standard (4 Sets + 1 Pair) OR Seven Pairs.
- ▶ **Condition A (Terminal):** Must include a 1 or 9.
Red Dragon counts as a terminal for this rule.
- ▶ **Condition B (Triplet):** Must have a Triplet (Peng: three identical tiles).
Red Dragon counts toward triplets as well.

Example

A standard win can be: **one 1/9 tile** somewhere in the hand, plus **one Peng** (e.g., 5 Dots–5 Dots–5 Dots).

Ting (Mandatory Ready)

Golden rule: you cannot win secretly.

- ▶ Declare **Ting** to lock your hand.
- ▶ After **Ting**, your **waiting tiles are fixed**.
- ▶ You cannot **change your hand** (no new **Chi/Peng** that alters your wait).

Example (teaching-friendly)

You are one tile away and waiting on **either** 3-Bamboo **or** 6-Bamboo.

When you declare **Ting**, you must keep that same wait until you win.

Snatching Ready

- ▶ You may **Chi** from **any** player (not only the left) **if** it lets you declare **Ting** immediately.
- ▶ If you cannot declare **Ting** right away, you cannot take that tile.

Example

You hold **4-Bamboo, 5-Bamboo**. Someone across the table discards **6-Bamboo**.

You can **Chi** (4-5-6) **only if** that makes you ready and you declare **Ting** immediately.

Treasury Tile

- ▶ **Generation:** The last tile on the wall is the **Treasury**.
- ▶ **Winning:** If you are in **Ting** and self-draw the **Treasury**, you win immediately.
- ▶ **Swap Rule:** If 3 copies of the **Treasury** are visible on the table, flip a new one.

Example

The **Treasury** is **8-Bamboo**. If you are already in **Ting** and self-draw **8-Bamboo**, you win.

Special Win: Blowing Big Wind

- ▶ **High-points local rule** for an immediate win.
- ▶ **Prerequisite:** You have already declared **Ting**.

Scenario (example with **6-Bamboo**)

- ▶ You already own a **triplet** of 6-Bamboo:
 - Case A: a **Peng** of 6-Bamboo is exposed on the table.
 - Case B: three 6-Bamboo are hidden in your hand.
- ▶ You **self-draw** the 4th 6-Bamboo.
- ▶ **Result:** You do **not** Kong you **WIN immediately**.

Drawing the 4th tile of a set you already own is called **Blowing Big Wind**.

Game Components (Reference)

Suit Tiles (4 copies each)

- ▶ **Dots** (1–9)
- ▶ **Bamboo** (1–9)
- ▶ **Characters** (1–9)

Special

- ▶ **Red Dragon**
- ▶ Total: **112 tiles**

(108 suit tiles + 4 Red Dragons = 112)

Mini Exercises (1/3)

Notation: **B** = Bamboo, **D** = Dots, **C** = Characters, **R** = Red Dragon.

- **Exercise A (Ting?)** You just drew and now hold 14 tiles:
B1 B2 B3 B4 B5 B6 C7 C8 C9 R R R D5 D6.

Can you declare **Ting**? If yes: what do you discard, and what are you waiting for?

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- ▶ **Exercise A (Ting?)** You just drew and now hold 14 tiles:
B1 B2 B3 B4 B5 B6 C7 C8 C9 R R R D5 D6.
Can you declare **Ting**? If yes: what do you discard, and what are you waiting for?
- ▶ **Answer:** Yes. Discard **D6** → declare **Ting**, waiting for **D5**.
- ▶ **Exercise B (Win?)** Continuing Exercise A: you already declared **Ting** (waiting for **D5**).
On your next draw you self-draw **D5**. Do you win?

Mini Exercises (1/3)

Notation: **B** = Bamboo, **D** = Dots, **C** = Characters, **R** = Red Dragon.

- ▶ **Exercise A (Ting?)** You just drew and now hold 14 tiles:
B1 B2 B3 B4 B5 B6 C7 C8 C9 R R R D5 D6.
Can you declare **Ting**? If yes: what do you discard, and what are you waiting for?
- ▶ **Answer:** Yes. Discard **D6** → declare **Ting**, waiting for **D5**.
- ▶ **Exercise B (Win?)** Continuing Exercise A: you already declared **Ting** (waiting for **D5**).
On your next draw you self-draw **D5**. Do you win?
- ▶ **Answer:** Yes. The hand becomes **4 sets + 1 pair**, includes a terminal (C9), and has a **Peng** (RRR).

Mini Exercises (2/3)

Same notation: B/D/C/R. Remember: legal wins require **Ting** + terminal + a **Peng**.

- ▶ **Exercise C (Ting trap)** You hold 14 tiles:
B1 B2 B3 B4 B5 B6 C2 C3 C4 D7 D8 D9 D5 D6.
If you discard **D6**, you would be “one tile away” by shape (waiting on **D5**).
Are you allowed to declare **Ting** under Harbin rules?

Mini Exercises (2/3)

Same notation: B/D/C/R. Remember: legal wins require **Ting** + terminal + a **Peng**.

- ▶ **Exercise C (Ting trap)** You hold 14 tiles:
B1 B2 B3 B4 B5 B6 C2 C3 C4 D7 D8 D9 D5 D6.
If you discard **D6**, you would be “one tile away” by shape (waiting on **D5**).
Are you allowed to declare **Ting** under Harbin rules?
- ▶ **Answer:** No. Even after drawing **D5**, the hand has **no Peng** (no triplet), so it is not a legal win.
- ▶ **Exercise D (Treasury)** The **Treasury** is **B2**. You see **three B2** already visible on the table. What happens next?

Mini Exercises (2/3)

Same notation: B/D/C/R. Remember: legal wins require **Ting** + terminal + a **Peng**.

- ▶ **Exercise C (Ting trap)** You hold 14 tiles:
B1 B2 B3 B4 B5 B6 C2 C3 C4 D7 D8 D9 D5 D6.
If you discard **D6**, you would be “one tile away” by shape (waiting on **D5**).
Are you allowed to declare **Ting** under Harbin rules?
- ▶ **Answer:** No. Even after drawing **D5**, the hand has **no Peng** (no triplet), so it is not a legal win.
- ▶ **Exercise D (Treasury)** The **Treasury** is **B2**. You see **three B2** already visible on the table. What happens next?
- ▶ **Answer:** Flip a new **Treasury** tile (swap rule).

Mini Exercises (3/3)

Same notation: B/D/C/R. Remember: **Blowing big wind** requires you are already in **Ting**.

- **Exercise E (Blowing big wind)** You are already in **Ting**. You have a **Peng** of **B6** (either exposed or hidden). You self-draw the 4th **B6**. What do you do?

Mini Exercises (3/3)

Same notation: B/D/C/R. Remember: **Blowing big wind** requires you are already in **Ting**.

- ▶ **Exercise E (Blowing big wind)** You are already in **Ting**. You have a **Peng** of **B6** (either exposed or hidden). You self-draw the 4th **B6**. What do you do?
- ▶ **Answer:** You win immediately (do **not** Kong). This is **Blowing big wind**.

The best way to learn is to play!

Thank you for reading it!